

Knight-ending routes

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



The defending king is on h4. Geometrically undefended: knight on e2. Check for tactical protection.



64...hxg5+ 65. Kg4 Kh6

65...Kh6 The king moves from g6 to h6.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from +0 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.